

SCORPIONFLIES

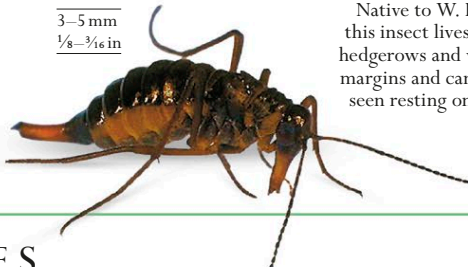
These predatory insects of the order Mecoptera generally have an elongated and cylindrical body. The large, narrow wings may be clear or marked with spots or bands of dark colour. Some species are short-winged or completely wingless. The head, which has large eyes and thread-like antennae, is characteristically extended downwards in the form of a beak, at the end of which are biting mouthparts.

SNOW SCORPIONFLY

Boreus hyemalis
F: Boreidae

The adult of this small, wingless European insect can only be seen in autumn and winter. It breeds among moss.

3–5 mm
1/8–3/16 in



COMMON SCORPIONFLY

Panorpa communis
F: Panorpidae

Native to W. Europe, this insect lives in shady hedgerows and woodland margins and can often be seen resting on nettles.

1.8–3 cm
3/4–1 in



FLEAS

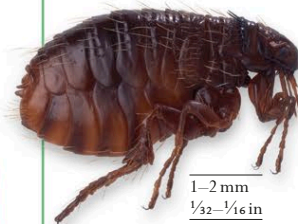
Members of the order Siphonaptera, fleas are laterally flattened, wingless, blood-sucking ectoparasites of mammals and some birds. Their head has short, piercing mouthparts and pairs of simple lateral eyes. The hind legs are highly specialized for jumping.

CAT FLEA

Ctenocephalides felis
F: Pulicidae

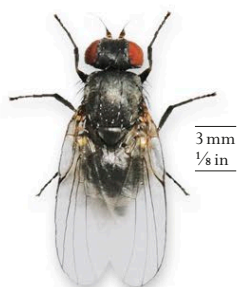
This species is very common worldwide. Also found on dogs, it can feed on the blood of several other animals, too – including humans.

1–2 mm
1/32–1/16 in



TRUE FLIES

True flies belong to the order Diptera, and are recognized by a single pair of membranous front wings. The hindwings are reduced, forming a pair of balancing organs called halteres. Most flies are beneficial to humans as pollinators, predators, and recyclers, but wild and domestic animals and many people are affected by fly-borne diseases. Some flies are also crop pests.

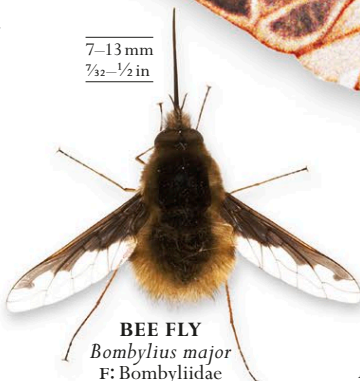


3 mm
1/8 in

AGROMYZA RONDENSIS

F: Agromyzidae

This small fly can be found all over Europe. The larvae make leaf mines in a wide variety of grass species.



7–13 mm
7/32–1/2 in

BEE FLY

Bombylius major
F: Bombyliidae

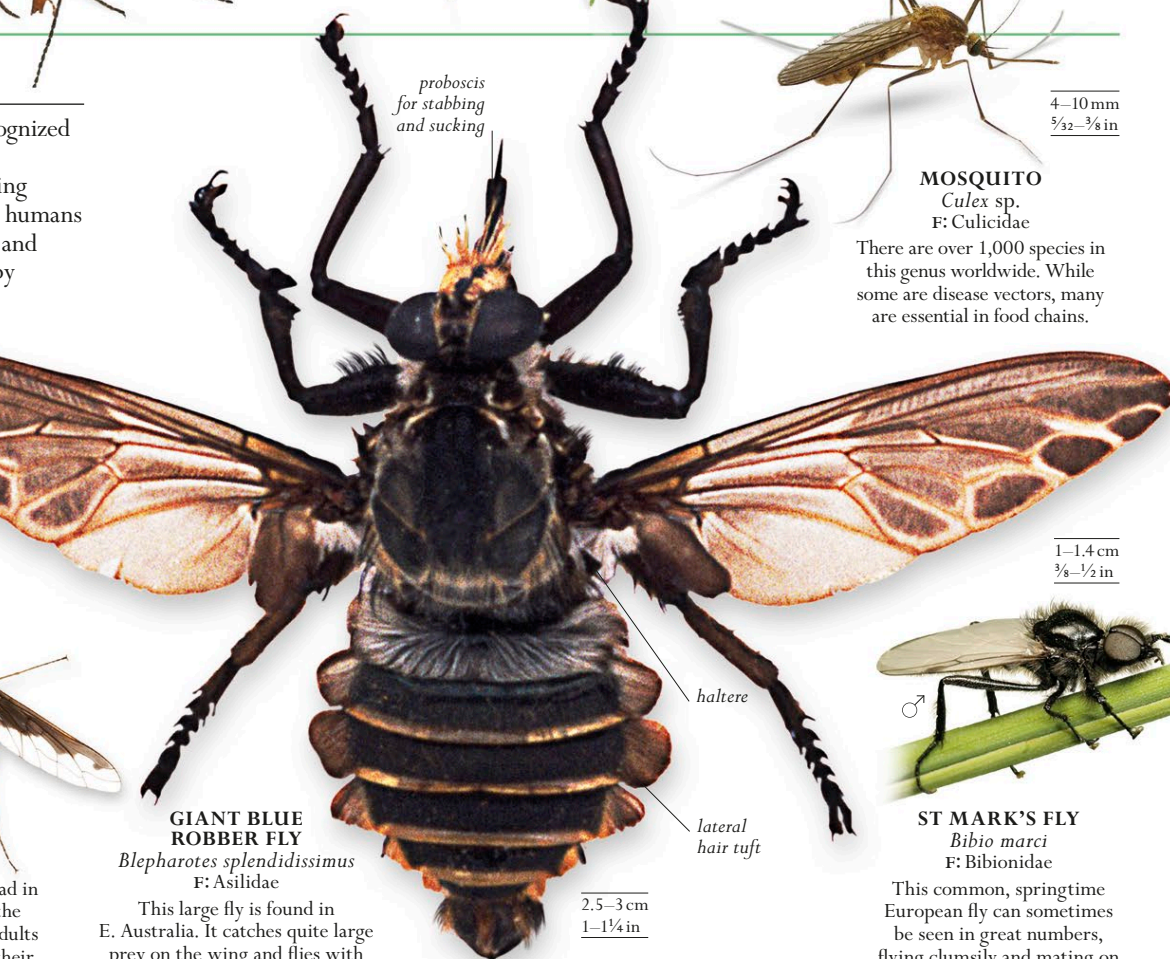
This species is widespread in temperate regions of the northern hemisphere. Adults are nectar-feeders and their larvae are parasites in bee nests.

GIANT BLUE ROBBER FLY

Blepharotes splendissimus
F: Asilidae

This large fly is found in E. Australia. It catches quite large prey on the wing and flies with a distinctive buzzing sound.

2.5–3 cm
1–1 1/4 in



proboscis
for stabbing
and sucking

haltere

lateral
hair tuft



1–1.4 cm
3/8–1/2 in

ST MARK'S FLY

Bibio marci
F: Bibionidae

This common, springtime European fly can sometimes be seen in great numbers, flying clumsily and mating on grass and low vegetation.

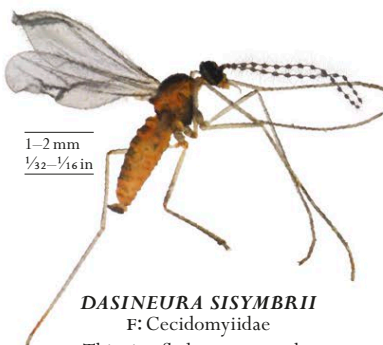


1–1.2 cm
3/8–1/2 in

PLATYURA MARGINATA

F: Keroplatidae

Widespread throughout W. Europe, this fly lives in wooded areas. The larvae live inside rotting wood, where they eat other small insects.

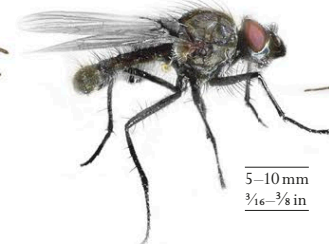


1–2 mm
1/32–1/16 in

DASINEURA SISYMBRII

F: Cecidomyiidae

This tiny fly lays eggs on the flower heads of field cress. A pale, spongy gall develops, inside which the larvae feed.

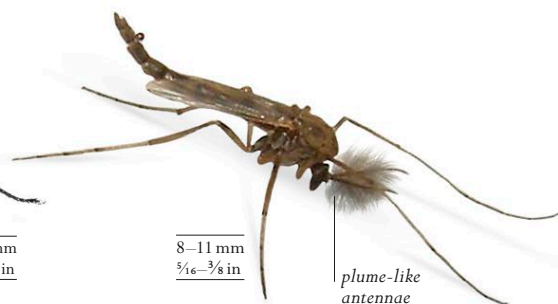


5–10 mm
3/16–3/8 in

CABBAGE ROOT FLY

Delia radicum
F: Anthomyiidae

This small European fly can be a serious pest of wild and cultivated brassicas such as cabbage, turnip, and rape.



8–11 mm
5/16–3/8 in

BUZZER MIDGE

Chironomus plumosus
F: Chironomidae

This fly is found all across the northern hemisphere. The larvae are called bloodworms and live in muddy-bottomed ponds.

plume-like
antennae